

Write a paragraph using any one of the prompts!

1

Reflect on why continuous learning is essential in a fast-changing world.

2

Analyze the reasons people procrastinate and suggest effective strategies to overcome it.

3

Evaluate whether AI tools help or hinder students' development of independent thinking.

SENTENCE STRUCTURE



Presenter:
Faculty of General Education
DIHPE

LEARNING OBJECTIVES



Differentiate between simple, compound and complex sentences.



Comprehend the importance and function of kinds of sentences in bringing the complexities in the text.



Produce different kinds of sentences to bring the variety in writing styles.

PHRASES AND CLAUSES

Phrases

- Group of words having no verbs
- Has no forms
- Examples:
 - i. Succeeding in school
 - ii. Working full time
 - iii. People who are happy
 - iv. Habits which annoy me

Clauses

- Building blocks of sentences
- Group of words having a subject and a verb
- Two kinds (dependent and independent)
- Examples:
 - i. Independent: Water evaporates rapidly in warm climate zones.
 - ii. Dependent: When the sun rises

SENTENCE STRUCTURES

Simple
Sentences

Compound
sentences

Complex
Sentences

Compound-
Complex
Sentences

CAN YOU IDENTIFY THE PROBLEMS HERE?

1 Rosa Parks is a famous African-American woman, **and** she is often called "the mother of the civil rights movement." She was born into a poor but hardworking African-American family in Alabama, **and** no one suspected that she would become the spark that ignited the civil rights movement in the United States. This movement changed U.S. society forever, **and** it helped African-Americans attain equal rights under the law.

Sounds Boring
(too many
compound
sentences)

2 Parks became famous quite by accident. One day in 1955, she was on her way home from her job in a Montgomery, Alabama, department store. She boarded a city bus with three other African-Americans. They sat in the fifth row. The fifth row was the first row African-Americans were allowed to sit in. A few stops later, the front four rows filled up. A white man was left standing.

Sounds Choppy
(too many
simple
sentences)

SIMPLE SENTENCES

- One independent clause.

Examples:

- Freshwater boils at 100 degrees Celsius at sea level.
- Freshwater boils at 100 degrees and freezes at 0 degrees.
- Freshwater and saltwater do not boil and do not freeze at the same time.

Subject

Verb



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COMPOUND SENTENCES

TWO OR MORE INDEPENDENT CLAUSES JOINED TOGETHER.

i. With a coordinator

Independent clause,
+ **coordinator** + independent
clause

- For example,
Saltwater boils at a lower
temperature than freshwater,
so food cooks faster in
saltwater.

(For, And, Nor, But, Or, Yet, So).

ii. With a conjunctive adverb

Independent clause;
+ **conjunctive adverb**, +
independent clause

- For example,
Saltwater boils at a higher
temperature than
freshwater; **therefore**, food
cooks faster in saltwater.

iii. With a semicolon(;)

Independent clause
+ **;** +
independent clause

- For example,
Poland was the first
Eastern European country
to turn away from
communism; others soon
followed.



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Coordinating Conjunctions: connects words, phrases or clauses within a single sentence.	Coordinating Conjunction	Function
	and	to join two ideas
	but	to contrast two ideas
	for	to indicate a reason
	nor	to indicate a negative idea
	or	to offer an alternative
	so	to indicate a cause and effect relationship
	yet	to introduce a surprising idea

Transitional Expressions

Addition	Alternative	Contrast	Time	Example or Emphasis	Result or Consequence
additionally	in fact	however	eventually	for example	consequently
also	instead	nevertheless	finally	for instance	hence
besides	on the contrary	nonetheless	later	namely	therefore
furthermore	on the other hand	still	meanwhile	of course	thus
in addition	otherwise		subsequently	undoubtedly	
moreover					

Transitional Signals or Conjunctive Adverbs: connect broader ideas across different sentences or paragraphs.

Read the following paragraphs and create compound sentences by adding semicolons, conjunctive adverbs (however, therefore, etc) or coordinating conjunctions.

1. Technology has permeated the field of health care. Computers, digital software, and new inventions have transformed medicine. There are both positive and negative effects of technology on health care.

Technology has permeated the field of health care. *, and computers* ~~Computers~~, digital software, and new inventions have transformed medicine. There are both positive and negative effects of technology on health care.

Read the following paragraphs and create compound sentences by adding semicolons, conjunctive adverbs (however, therefore, etc) or coordinating conjunctions.

2. Indeed, new medical innovations help countless people. Michael Price has Parkinson's disease. His hands shake a lot. In the past, he could not type reports at work. Modern technology now enables him to be self-sufficient. He dictates into a microphone attached to a computer. The software allows him to correct mistakes verbally. Some people use electric wheelchairs for mobility. Others with paralysis have battery-powered diaphragm pacers. Such devices allow the users to breathe normally. Journalist Charles Krauthammer uses a computerized van. He was paralyzed in a diving accident many years ago.

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COMPLEX SENTENCES

- One independent clause and one (or more) dependent clause(s).

Examples:

- Although women in the United States could own property, they could not vote until 1920.
- A citizen can vote in the United States when he or she is 18 years old.
- The robber who broke into my house is in court today.
- No one is absolutely sure when the Maori people first appeared in New Zealand.

Dependent clauses

Independent clauses



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COMPOUND-COMPLEX SENTENCES

- At least three clauses and two independent clauses are a must.
- Examples:
 - After I graduated from college, I wanted to travel, but I had to go to work immediately.
 - I wanted to travel after I graduated from college, but I had to go to work immediately because I had to support my family.

Independent clauses

Dependent clauses



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Subordinating Conjunctions: connects words, phrases or clauses within a single sentence.	Subordinating Conjunction	Usage
	as, because, since, so that	To indicate a reason, a cause, or an effect
	as long as, even if, if, so that, unless	To indicate a condition or result
	although, even though, though, whereas	To contrast ideas
	where, wherever	To indicate a location
	after, before, since, until, when, whenever, while	To show a point in time

The following paragraphs contain simple sentences. To give the paragraphs more sentence variety, transform a few sentences into complex sentences.

- Ironworkers have one of the most dangerous jobs. Many people like that job. In the past, high-rise builders had to be very careful. They had no safety equipment. For example, workers built the Empire State building. They had to walk on beams 102 stories high. The ironworkers had no head protection or special boots. The risks were great. Today, all workers wear hard hats and safety harnesses. Construction companies must provide those items.

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The following paragraphs contain simple sentences. To give the paragraphs more sentence variety, transform a few sentences into complex sentences.

- People study engineering. They have to consider the integrity of structures. Tall buildings must be carefully designed. They have to withstand high winds. The foundations must be solid. They can shift during earthquakes. Modern skyscrapers are made with steel frames. They must bear the weight of hundreds of windows. Sometimes engineers design buildings. They make mistakes. For instance, the John Hancock Tower in Boston has mirrored glass. The glass is not secure during high winds. Huge panels of glass weigh up to 500 pounds. They have fallen to the pavement. Luckily, the glass has not hit pedestrians.



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Now, examine your written paragraphs and
 underline the names of sentence structures you
 have used.



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Sentence Type	Main Function	Example	Effect
Simple	State a single, strong idea clearly.	The results were unexpected.	Direct, emphatic, easy to process.
Compound	Link equal ideas to show coordination or contrast.	The results were unexpected, but they supported the hypothesis.	Balances two related ideas; shows logical connection.
Complex	Show dependence — one idea depends on or explains another.	Although the results were unexpected, they supported the hypothesis.	Emphasizes the main clause while providing context or condition.
Compound-Complex	Combine coordination and subordination for depth.	Although the results were unexpected, they supported the hypothesis, and further studies confirmed the trend.	Demonstrates nuanced thinking; ideal for advanced academic writing.

THANK YOU

References:

Writing Academic English by Alice Oshima and Ann Hogue.